

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS



SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY



A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 33

INFORMATION & COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT) - 14

INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)

NATIONAL DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS POLICY 2018

- With a view to cater to the needs of the digital communications sector of India, the Union Cabinet approved the National Digital Communications Policy-2018 (NDCP-2018).
- The new policy has been formulated in place of the existing National Telecom Policy-2012 and aims to facilitate India's effective participation in the global digital economy.
- The policy aims to ensure **Digital Sovereignty** and the other objectives are to be achieved by 2022.



NATIONAL DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS POLICY 2018

KEY OBJECTIVES OF THE POLICY

- Provide universal broadband connectivity at 50 Mbps to every citizen.
- Provide 1 Gbps connectivity to all Gram Panchayats by 2020 and 10 Gbps by 2022.
- Ensure connectivity to all uncovered areas.
- Attract investments of USD 100 billion in the Digital Communications Sector.
- Train one million manpower for building New Age Skill.
- Expand IoT ecosystem to 5 billion connected devices.
- Establish a comprehensive data protection regime for digital communications that safeguards the privacy, autonomy and choice of individuals.



NATIONAL DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS POLICY 2018

KEY OBJECTIVES OF THE POLICY

- Facilitate India's effective participation in the global digital economy.
- Enforce accountability through appropriate institutional mechanisms to assure citizens of safe and secure digital communications infrastructure and services.
- Enhancing the contribution of the Digital Communications sector to 8% of India's GDP from ~ 6% in 2017;
- Propelling India to the Top 50 Nations in the ICT Development Index of ITU from 134 in 2017.



NATIONAL DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS POLICY 2018

DIGITAL/DATA SOVEREIGNTY

- Data sovereignty is the concept that a consumer's digital data and presence should be entirely under consumer control. In other words, it should be up to an individual to decide who can access, store, and use their data, and for what purposes.
- Digital sovereignty means that internet users can freely and independently decide which data can be gathered, distributed, used and saved about them.
- Whenever we use a digital service, we leave a trail of data behind which is taken up by organizations. Because of this, data sovereignty is compromised.



DIGITAL/DATA SOVEREIGNTY

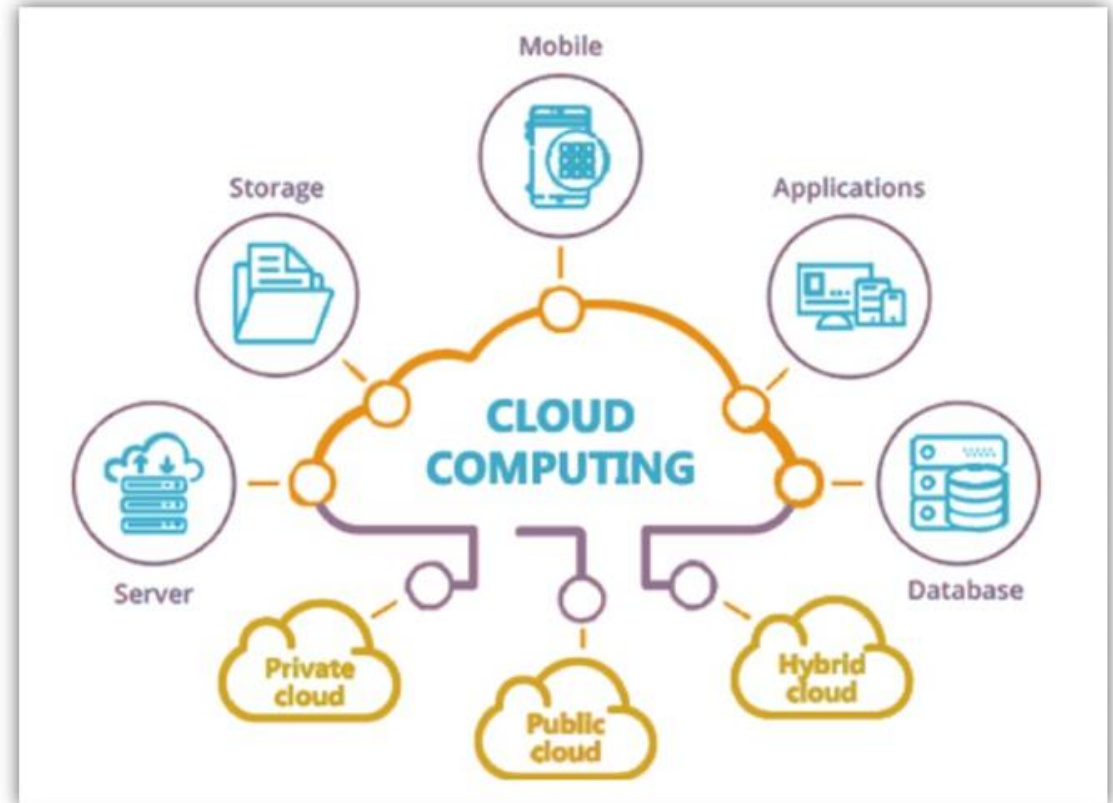
- Are we transforming ourselves from users and customers of digital providers to suppliers for their business models?
- Data is the commodity of the 21st century. It is a central element for new business concepts and the future of production. For companies, it is a way to optimize their products and make profit.
- So, while data collection and processing it is great for the economy, the catch is there is no transparency in this area. Users are insufficiently informed which data is being collected and what happens with it. They cannot control their own data.



NATIONAL DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS POLICY 2018

THE OTHER ISSUE

- Digitisation of data makes it easy to duplicate, portable and large amount of data can be stored. However, most of the data is stored in the cloud and the data storage centres are not located within the country from where the data is uploaded.
- The spread of cloud computing has made it cheaper and easier to access and store data, but it comes with its downsides. Storing data in the cloud can mean that digital sovereignty is further compromised by differences in cross border laws, as there are currently no global, universal rules.





NATIONAL DIGITAL COMMUNICATIONS POLICY 2018

THE OTHER ISSUE

- Different countries and locations have their own privacy and data laws that can vary widely. This means that data stored in one country could be used for purposes that the host country (where the consumer actually lives) would not allow.
- This raises great concerns for individuals, government and IT professionals.
- Digital sovereignty or Data sovereignty is all about storage and protection of an individual's personal data in digital form on cloud. Data sovereignty demands that the individual's data which is stored in the binary digital form in the cloud, must be kept within the country in which the individual resides and it must be subject to the laws of that country.



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